



9-Day Glencoe to Oban Walking Adventure

A Scenic Scottish Highlands Walking Holiday with Luggage Transfer

9

Days

~90

Miles

8

B&Bs

Trip Overview

Experience the dramatic beauty of the Scottish Highlands on this 9-day walking holiday from Glencoe to Oban. Each day features approximately 10 miles of scenic hiking through some of Scotland's most stunning landscapes, including ancient glens, mountain passes, coastal paths, and historic sites. Your luggage is transported between accommodations, so you only need to carry a daypack while enjoying carefully selected B&Bs along the route.



Glencoe



Kinlochleven



Ballachulish



Appin



Oban



Luggage Transfer Service

Like Walk About Scotland and other premier walking holiday operators, we arrange for your luggage to be transported daily from one B&B to the next. You simply pack your bags in the morning, and they'll be waiting for you at your next accommodation. You only need to carry a daypack with essentials for the day's walk.



AMS Luggage Transfers - Official Website

1

Arrival in Glencoe



Day 1



Glencoe Village



Walking: Short orientation walk (3-4 miles) - Easy



View Glencoe Area on Google Maps

Activities:

- ✓ Arrive in Glencoe Village and check into your B&B
- ✓ Orientation walk around Glencoe Village
- ✓ Visit the Glencoe Visitor Centre to learn about the area's geology and history

✓ Short walk to Signal Rock and An Torr viewpoint

✓ Evening meal at local pub

✓ Early night to prepare for tomorrow's full walking day

★ Highlights:

The dramatic mountains of Glencoe provide an awe-inspiring introduction to the Highlands. The valley is steeped in history, including the infamous 1692 Massacre of Glencoe.



Accommodation:

B&B in Glencoe Village - Traditional Highland hospitality with mountain views



Example B&Bs: [Scorrybreac Guest House](#) | [Glencoe House](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Shorter route (3-4 miles): Take a gentle orientation walk to Signal Rock and the An Torr viewpoint, then return via the River Coe path. This provides excellent valley views without the full hike to Loch Achtriochtan.

2

Glencoe Valley Exploration

July
17

Day 2

 Glencoe Village



Walking: 10 miles - Moderate



Duration: 5-6 hours



Elevation: +1,600 ft



View Route to Lost Valley on Google Maps

Today's Walk:

- ✓ Follow the lower slopes of Aonach Eagach ridge
- ✓ Walk through the Lost Valley (Coire Gabhail) - a hidden glacial valley
- ✓ Pass the Meeting of Three Waters (confluence of rivers)
- ✓ Return via the River Coe path with stunning valley views
- ✓ Wildlife spotting opportunities - red deer, golden eagles



Highlights:

The Lost Valley is a geological wonder where Clan MacDonald once hid their stolen cattle. The walk offers some of the most dramatic mountain scenery in Scotland.



Accommodation:

B&B in Glencoe Village - Same accommodation as Day 1

 Example B&Bs: [Scorrybreac Guest House](#) | [Glencoe House](#)

 Alternative Walk Option:

Shorter route (5-6 miles): Walk to the entrance of the Lost Valley but skip the steep scramble into the upper valley. Instead, explore the lower reaches and Meeting of Three Waters before returning via the well-marked River Coe path. This reduces elevation gain by about 800 ft.

3

Glencoe to Kinlochleven

 July 17

Day 3



Kinlochleven



Walking: 11 miles - Moderate to Challenging



Duration: 6-7 hours



Elevation: +1,800 ft



Luggage: Transferred to Kinlochleven B&B



View Route to Kinlochleven on Google Maps

Today's Walk:

✓ Follow part of the West Highland Way from Altnafeadh

✓ Climb to the Devil's Staircase (highest point of West Highland Way at 1,800 ft)

✓ Spectacular panoramic views from the summit

✓ Descend through moorland into Kinlochleven

✓ Pass by the dramatic Blackwater Reservoir

✓ Arrive in the former aluminum smelting village

★ Highlights:

The Devil's Staircase offers breathtaking 360-degree views across the Highlands. On clear days, you can see Ben Nevis, Britain's highest mountain.



Accommodation:

B&B in Kinlochleven - Cozy village accommodation with excellent local restaurants



Example B&Bs: [Allt-na-Leven House](#) | [Macdonald Hotel](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Road route (8 miles): Follow the A82 road and minor roads to Kinlochleven, avoiding the Devil's Staircase climb entirely. This scenic low-level route follows Glen Coe and offers easier walking with minimal elevation gain (+300 ft). Can arrange a lift for the last section if preferred.

4

Kinlochleven to Ballachulish



Day 4



Ballachulish



Walking: 9 miles - Easy to Moderate



Duration: 4-5 hours



Elevation: +800 ft



Luggage: Transferred to Ballachulish B&B



View Route to Ballachulish on Google Maps

Today's Walk:

- ✓ Follow forest paths along Loch Leven's southern shore
- ✓ Walk through native oak and birch woodland
- ✓ Visit the site of the historic Ballachulish slate quarries
- ✓ Cross the Ballachulish Bridge with views to Loch Linnhe
- ✓ Explore the village and learn about the slate industry heritage
- ✓ Optional visit to nearby Glencoe village

★ Highlights:

Ballachulish slate roofed buildings across Britain for 300 years. The quarry site is now a peaceful nature area with interpretive displays.



Accommodation:

B&B in Ballachulish - Comfortable accommodation with loch views



Example B&Bs: [Ballachulish House](#) | [The Ferns B&B](#) | [Loch Linnhe B&B](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Shorter route (6 miles): Take the more direct path along the loch shore, bypassing some of the inland forest sections. Or arrange a taxi/bus for part of the journey and walk only the final scenic 4 miles along Loch Leven to Ballachulish Bridge.

5

Ballachulish Circular Walk



Day 5



Ballachulish



Walking: 10 miles - Moderate



Duration: 5-6 hours



Elevation: +1,200 ft



View Ballachulish Area on Google Maps

Today's Walk:

- ✓ Circular walk to Sgorr Dhearg and Sgorr Dhonuill viewpoints
- ✓ Climb through ancient Caledonian pine forest remnants
- ✓ Panoramic views over Loch Leven and Glencoe mountains
- ✓ Descend past waterfalls and through heather moorland
- ✓ Return to Ballachulish along the shore path
- ✓ Relaxing evening in the village

★ Highlights:

This circular walk offers some of the best viewpoints in the area without the need to move accommodations - a perfect mid-trip rest day.



Accommodation:

B&B in Ballachulish - Same accommodation as Day 4



Example B&Bs: [Ballachulish House](#) | [The Ferns B&B](#) | [Loch Linnhe B&B](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Easier option (4-5 miles): Take a gentle stroll along the Loch Leven shoreline path from Ballachulish to North Ballachulish and back. Flat, easy walking with beautiful views. Or visit nearby

Glencoe Village (short drive) for a relaxed pub lunch and local crafts shopping.

6

Ballachulish to Appin

 Day 6

 Appin



Walking: 11 miles - Easy to Moderate



Duration: 5-6 hours



Elevation: +600 ft



Luggage: Transferred to Appin B&B



View Route to Appin on Google Maps

Today's Walk:

- ✓ Walk south along Loch Linnhe's scenic coastal path
- ✓ Pass through oak and birch woodlands rich with wildlife
- ✓ Visit the ruins of Castle Stalker viewpoint (iconic island castle)
- ✓ Walk through the historic Appin region
- ✓ Explore Port Appin harbor village
- ✓ Optional ferry to Lismore Island for views

★ Highlights:

Castle Stalker, sitting on its tidal island, is one of Scotland's most photographed castles. The Appin area features prominently in Robert Louis Stevenson's "Kidnapped."



Accommodation:

B&B in Port Appin - Charming coastal village with seafood restaurants



Example B&Bs: [Airds Hotel](#) | [Port Appin Hotel](#) | [The Pierhouse Hotel](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Shorter coastal route (8 miles): Follow the coastal path more directly to Port Appin, reducing inland detours. Alternatively, walk the first 6 miles to Castle Stalker viewpoint, then arrange pickup for the final section into Port Appin.

7

Appin Coastal Exploration

July 17

Day 7



Appin



Walking: 10 miles - Easy



Duration: 5 hours



Elevation: +400 ft



View Appin Coastal Area on Google Maps

Today's Walk:

- ✓ Circular coastal walk around Appin peninsula
- ✓ Visit the Appin Murder Monument (historic 1752 incident)
- ✓ Walk to Airds Bay with views across to Lismore and Mull
- ✓ Spot seals, otters, and seabirds along the shore
- ✓ Explore tidal pools and rocky beaches
- ✓ Return via inland farm tracks and woodland paths

★ Highlights:

The Appin Murder is one of Scotland's most famous unsolved crimes, inspiring Robert Louis Stevenson's novel. The coastal views are spectacular.



Accommodation:

B&B in Port Appin - Same accommodation as Day 6



Example B&Bs: [Airds Hotel](#) | [Port Appin Hotel](#) | [The Pierhouse Hotel](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Lismore Island excursion (varies): Take the ferry to Lismore Island for a change of scenery. Walk the island's quiet roads and paths (4-8 miles depending on route) with stunning 360-degree views. Return on the afternoon ferry. Or simply enjoy a rest day exploring Port Appin village and harbor.

8

Appin to Connel

July
17

Day 8

 Connel (near Oban)**Walking:** 12 miles - Moderate**Duration:** 6 hours**Elevation:** +800 ft**Luggage:** Transferred to Connel B&B**View Route to Connel on Google Maps**

Today's Walk:

- ✓ Walk south through Glen Creran forests
- ✓ Pass by ancient oak woodlands and cascading streams
- ✓ Cross moorland with views to Ben Cruachan
- ✓ Descend to Loch Etive at its tidal narrows
- ✓ View the Falls of Lora (tidal rapids under Connel Bridge)
- ✓ Arrive in Connel village

★ Highlights:

The Falls of Lora are unusual tidal rapids that occur when Loch Etive's waters rush through the narrow strait. They're best viewed at specific tide times.



Accommodation:

B&B in Connel - Peaceful village just north of Oban with excellent local amenities



Example B&Bs: [Rowan Bank Guest House](#) | [Connel Hotel](#) | [Ards House](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Shorter inland route (9 miles): Take the more direct forest tracks through Glen Creran, reducing the distance slightly. Or arrange taxi/bus transport for the first 4 miles, then walk the final scenic 8 miles descending to Loch Etive and Connel.

9

Connel to Oban - Final Day

July
17

Day 9



Oban



Walking: 9 miles - Easy



Duration: 4-5 hours



Elevation: +400 ft



Luggage: Transferred to Oban accommodation



View Route to Oban on Google Maps

Today's Walk:



Follow the coastal path from Connel to Oban

- ✓ Walk along Loch Etive and Loch Linnhe shores
- ✓ Pass through Dunstaffnage with its ancient castle
- ✓ Arrive in Oban, the "Gateway to the Isles"
- ✓ Celebrate at one of Oban's excellent seafood restaurants
- ✓ Visit McCaig's Tower for sunset views over the harbor
- ✓ Optional: Visit Oban Distillery for a whisky tasting

★ Highlights:

Oban is a beautiful Victorian harbor town and major ferry port. McCaig's Tower, resembling Rome's Colosseum, offers stunning views. Celebrate your achievement with fresh seafood and local whisky!



Accommodation:

Hotel or B&B in Oban - Town center location with harbor views and dining options



Example accommodations: [Manor House Hotel](#) | [The Royal Hotel](#) | [Kilchrenan House](#) | [Glenburnie House Hotel](#)



Alternative Walk Option:

Shorter route (6 miles): Walk the direct coastal path from Connel to Oban, skipping the Dunstaffnage Castle detour. Or take the bus/taxi to Dunstaffnage, then walk only the final scenic 4 miles along the coast into Oban town center and harbor.

Essential Trip Tips:

- **Best Season:** May to September for best weather and longest daylight hours
- **What to Pack:** Waterproof jacket and trousers, sturdy hiking boots, daypack, water bottle, sunscreen, midges repellent (summer), hat and gloves (spring/autumn)
- **Fitness Level:** Moderate - daily walks of 9-12 miles with some elevation gain
- **Luggage:** Pack light - one main bag (transferred daily) and a daypack
- **Weather:** Scottish weather is changeable - be prepared for rain, wind, and sun in the same day
- **Midges:** Tiny biting insects are prevalent June-August, especially in still, damp conditions. Bring repellent!
- **Food:** Most B&Bs offer excellent Scottish breakfasts. Pack lunch provisions or arrange with your B&B
- **Phone Signal:** Can be limited in remote areas - download offline maps

What's Included:

- ✓ 8 nights' accommodation in carefully selected B&Bs
- ✓ Daily breakfast at each B&B
- ✓ Daily luggage transfer between accommodations
- ✓ Detailed route notes and maps
- ✓ 24/7 emergency support during your trip
- ✓ Pre-trip information pack with local recommendations

Not Included:

- ✗ Transportation to Glencoe and from Oban

- X Lunches and evening meals
- X Travel insurance
- X Personal expenses

Ready for Your Scottish Walking Adventure?

This itinerary provides a perfect blend of challenging walks, stunning scenery, comfortable accommodations, and Scottish hospitality. Each day brings new landscapes and experiences while luggage transfer ensures you travel light and focus on enjoying the journey.

Note: This is a sample itinerary. Actual walking holidays can be customized based on fitness levels, time availability, and preferences.